

Standard Oil of New Jersey
Sears, Roebuck & Company
Central and Southwest Corporation
New York Chicago & St. Louis Railroad
Thompson Ramo Wooldridge

By the time these were all bought, over a period of six months, and locked up in her safe-deposit box, she was an avid *aficionada* of the second section of the *New York Times*, where the market quotations are listed, and, as her holdings grew, she took to telephoning me at the queerest hours.

"Dolling," she would coo in her best semi-British accent, "what's wrong with Jehsey Standard? It's ecting *owfly* queah, down a half point today, down three eights yestah-day. It's rilly *veddy* odd—what's wrong?"

One evening I was paged in the Hotel Plaza's Oak Room. I was sure that my husband's plane had crashed or that my daughter had been expelled from college, and was most relieved and soon most exasperated to find that it was only Muffin.

"Do you think that my Nickel Plate is *rilly* safe?" Her voice came to me dimly above the clatter of dishes. "I've just been to a cocktail potty and met a man theah who says that railroads are a veddy risky investment—honestly, dolling, I'm just teddibly worried."

And later on that week: "Dolling, I'm calling from the Stork. Have you *seen* what's happening to Seahs? It's too *ghastly*!"

This sort of thing went on intermittently until President Eisenhower's heart attack. That day the Dow-Jones averages declined 31.89 points from 487.45 to 455.56. Muffin telephoned from Hollywood. She was hysterical.

"I'm ruined," she sobbed. "Everything is lost. I can't *stand* it."

I tried to reassure her but it didn't work at all. She was beside herself.